

Gmail

Sign Out Properly

In Netscape, Mozilla and Firefox, if you close the Gmail tab, not the window, you're still signed in. Anybody can open a new tab and go to Gmail and automatically get logged into your account. It's therefore a good habit to sign out from a Gmail session by clicking the 'Sign out' link on the top right corner.

Compose In A New Window

Pressing [Shift] brings up a new window for composing. This is assuming your pop-up blocker is off. For example, when you press [Shift] and click on 'Compose Mail', a new window pops up for composition. You can also use [Shift] in conjunction with 'Reply', 'Reply All', and 'Forward'.

A Secure Gmail Session

Gmail lets you have a secure HTTPS session via <https://gmail.google.com>. Use this link if you're paranoid about security!

Return To The Inbox

To return to the inbox, you can, of course, click on the 'Inbox' link on the left-hand side, or if you're in conversation view, click on the 'Back to Inbox' link above the conversation.

There is a green 'Inbox' label text next to the subject. You can also click the Gmail logo, a much larger target, to go back to the inbox. Clicking on the logo, the 'Inbox' link, or the 'Refresh' link will refresh the 'Inbox' with the latest messages received.



Click any of the three areas indicated to see a refreshed Inbox!

Tips & Tricks

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Selecting A Sub-Conversation

Have you ever had a long, multi-person conversation, and you wanted to concentrate on a particular sub-conversation with one person?

Let's say you e-mailed three of your friends, Aditya, Bob, and Renuka, with the subject "Going okay?" and asked them all "How's it going with you?"

They all replied back and now you've gotten into three separate sub-conversations, all within the same Gmail conversation. There is an easy way to concentrate on your sub-conversation with, say, Aditya. Simply do the following search (without the square brackets):
[subject:"going okay" (from:aditya OR to:aditya)]

Then when you click on the conversation, it will open up with only the matching messages expanded.

The "to:" operator finds stuff in the to/cc/bcc fields. If you also cc-ed or bcc-ed Aditya in other messages that you don't want to match the search (e.g. in your messages to Bob and Renuka), then do the search:

[subject:"going okay" (from:aditya OR (to:aditya -cc:aditya -bcc:aditya))]
The "-cc:aditya" and "-bcc:aditya" terms eliminate the possibility of matching on messages cc-ed or bcc-ed to Aditya.

Sending Shortcuts

Send mail to fellow Gmailers by entering the username in the 'To', 'Cc', or 'Bcc' area. There's no need to include '@gmail.com'!

If your e-mail address is first.name.lastname@gmail.com, and now you wish you didn't have the period, you're in luck. For some reason, Gmail treats that e-mail address the same as one without a period (and vice-versa), so firstnamelastname@gmail.com works just as well as first.name.lastname@gmail.com. Gmail is flexible with regards to capitalisations, too!

Searching For Names

In Gmail, "or" is not the same as "OR". Only the capitalised version (sans quotes) will work with searches. Also, the actual search terms are not case-sensitive. "adi" works just as good as "Adi". Using the same example, it's important to realise that the search engine of Gmail does not search partial words. So "adi" will not find "Aditya".

Performing Actions On A Group Of E-mails

Let's say you have 150 e-mails, listed over two pages (100 maximum per page), and you want to archive all of them.

You might make the mistake of clicking 'All', then hitting 'Archive' and thinking that this would do the trick. It doesn't. Commands such as 'Trash', 'Archive' or 'Label' only affect items that are both selected and on the page you're currently viewing.

Don't forget that when you archive or label e-mail, you're affecting the entire conversation of e-mails by default. If you want to trash just one of the e-mails in a conversation, you can do this by expanding that particular e-mail, clicking on 'More Options', and then clicking 'Trash this message'.

Importing Contacts Into Gmail

To import contacts into Gmail the 'official' way, you'll need to export a CSV file from your other mail account, and then import it into Gmail.

To import your Yahoo! Mail address book, save your file as a Yahoo! CSV. Instructions are available in the Yahoo! Address Book help section at:

<http://snipurl.com/gefa>

Here's a way to export your contacts from Hotmail to Gmail.

Using Internet Explorer:

Sign in to your Hotmail account. Click the 'Contacts' tab. Click 'Print View'. Align the cursor with the first letter of the 'Name' column. Highlight your contacts by holding down the cursor and